

Russell Dudek

PROCESS EXCELLENCE, AUTOMATION & OPERATING TRANSFORMATION LEADER



Russell Dudek

Pittsburgh, PA · Planning relocation to Tampa/St. Petersburg
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linkedin.com/in/russelldudek
russelldudek.github.io/USAA/

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Operator-technologist who makes complex work visible, connects technical and business teams, and builds operating mechanisms that turn emerging technology into adopted, measurable outcomes. Brings more than eight years designing and implementing business solutions, direct people leadership, process controls, Lean/Gemba practice, workflow automation, and cross-functional operating transformation.

ROLE-ALIGNED VALUE

- **Process excellence:** Standard work, root cause, performance measures, fact-based prioritization, and process controls across high-reliability engineering, manufacturing, logistics, and service environments.
- **Automation strategy:** Opportunity framing across value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- **Leadership:** Builds teams, operating cadence, coaching systems, escalation paths, and accountability mechanisms that make standards usable.
- **Risk-conscious delivery:** Connects human authority, evidence, monitoring, and fallback to the workflow rather than treating governance as a post-launch review.

CANDIDATE THESIS

Scale the workflow and its assurance together.

Automation earns scale when member/employee outcomes and ownership/control evidence improve as one system.

CREDENTIALS

Google AI Essentials
IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner
Six Sigma Certification
OSHA 10

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Agentic AI · LLM workflows · RAG · Human-in-the-loop design · Python · SQL · JavaScript · TensorFlow · Tableau · Odoo · Jira · Confluence · HubSpot · Slack

EXPERIENCE

Vape-Jet 2025 - Present

Director of Operations

- Leads AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Connects factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Works in a software-enabled robotics and machine-vision environment with approximately 1,000 fielded robots informing support and operating feedback loops.

DudeWorth 2017 - Present

Founder / AI and Automation Advisor

- Develops AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks that assess value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Designs agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.

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EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Cardinal Building Products

2021 - 2023

Regional Director

- Built the company's first remote regional operation.
- Modernized distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital marketing, SEO, and online-buying workflows.
- Advanced AI-enhanced transportation-management and route-planning concepts.

ZeusVu

2018 - 2022

Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems and Aerial Data Operations

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real-estate, and restricted-airspace contexts with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed TensorFlow-based concepts for automated aerial inventory and computer-vision-enabled field intelligence.
- Designed medical drone delivery and chain-of-custody concepts connecting technology, risk, stakeholders, and governed execution.

Amazon

2014 - 2018

Operations Management / Site Leader

- Led launch and execution for Amazon Prime Pittsburgh in a 24/7 customer-backward operating environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, standard work, and operating mechanisms.
- Applied Lean and Gemba practices across safety, quality, throughput, customer experience, and team engagement.
- Contributed to logistics innovation through Prime Air research and Amazon Flex geolocation concepts.

Compunetics

2000 - 2013

Director of Operations and Engineering Management

- Progressed through R&D program management, production management, strategic acquisition, operations management, and director-level leadership.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in advanced electronics and high-reliability environments.
- Built quality systems, standard work, root-cause practices, performance measures, and process controls.
- Collaborated with high-consequence customers and partners including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD; published industry articles, delivered technical talks, and participated in the HyperTransport Consortium.

ADDITIONAL LEADERSHIP

Enviro Social Capital - Chairman of the Board, 2014-2017

Co-founded and led a public-private impact initiative; helped shape and evaluate a \$200 million Social Impact Bond feasibility concept for Pittsburgh green-infrastructure improvement.

IEEE - CMPT and EDS Pittsburgh Chapter Chair, 2012-2016

Led regional technology programming connecting industry, academia, STEM outreach, electronics, manufacturing, and emerging technology.

EDUCATION AND LOCATION

University of Pittsburgh

Bachelor of Science

Location: Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania. Planning relocation to the Tampa/St. Petersburg region; recognizes USAA's four-day in-office requirement and absence of relocation assistance.

Candidate vision: russelldudek.github.io/USAA/